Michael A. Navarrete
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Employment

Assistant Policy Adviser and Economist, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta, August 2025-Present
Postdoctoral Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research, July 2024-June 2025
Alice Rivlin Dissertation Fellow, Brookings Institution, November 2022-August 2024

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, 2024
M.A. Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, 2021
B.A. Economics and French, Williams College, 2016

Research Interests

Measurement, Macroeconomics, Labor Economics

Working Papers

"Geospatial Heterogeneity in Inflation: A Market Concentration Story" with Seula Kim (Atlanta Fed Working Paper 2025-15)

"COBOLing Together UI Benefits: How Delays in Fiscal Stabilizers Affect Aggregate Consumption" (Atlanta Fed Working Paper 2025-14). Reject & Resubmit, *Journal of Labor Economics*

"Firm Data on AI" with Ivan Yotzov, Jose Maria Barrero, Nicholas Bloom, Philip Bunn, Steven J. Davis, Kevin M. Foster, Aaron Jalca, Brent H. Meyer, Paul Mizen, Pawel Smietanka, Gregory Thwaites, and Ben Zhe Wang (NBER Working Paper 34836)

"The Wisdom of the Crowd? Firm Expectations, Disagreement, and Real GDP Forecast Accuracy" with Brent Meyer, Emil Mihaylov, and Daniel Weitz (Atlanta Fed Working Paper 2026-17)

Publications

"Lack of Uniform Prices or Lack of Uniform Retailers?" with Seula Kim
AEA Papers and Proceedings, May 2026

Work in Progress

"Measuring Real Sales and Inflation: Official Statistics vs Economics Transactions Data" with Gabriel Ehrlich, John Haltiwanger, David Johnson, Seula Kim, Jake Kramer, Edward Olivares, R. Benjamin Rodriguez, and Matthew Shapiro

"Unemployment Benefits and Business Formation" with Joonkyu Choi, Samuel Messer, and Veronika Penciakova

"Intergenerational Heterogeneity in Real Measures: A Migration Story" with Alvaro Silva

Policy Publications

"Geographic Inequality in Food Inflation," February 2026, *Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta Policy Hub*, with Seula Kim

"Redefining Digital Access: A Case Study in Unemployment Insurance," January 2025, *American Economic Association Minority Report*, with Luisa Blanco

Research and Relevant Work Experience

Special Sworn Status (SSS) Researcher, U.S. Census Bureau, 2024-Present
Economist, Economic Measurement and Research Internship, U.S. Census Bureau, 2020-2024
Research Assistant, Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, 2016-2018
Research Assistant, Williams College, 2015-2016
Research Fellow, American Economic Association, Summer 2015

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Introductory Macroeconomics, University of Maryland, Summer 2021, Winter 2022, Summer 2022, Winter 2023
Teaching Assistant, Labor Markets, University of Maryland, Spring 2020 and Fall 2020
Teaching Assistant, Introductory Macroeconomics, University of Maryland, Fall 2019
Teaching Assistant, Differential Equations, Williams College, Spring 2016

Grants and Awards

Postdoctoral Fellowship, National Bureau of Economic Research, 2024-2025
Doctoral Research Grant, Washington Center for Equitable Growth, 2023–2024 (Seula Kim, co-PI)
AEA Mentoring Program Conference Travel Support, American Economic Association, 2023–2025
BSOS Dean's Research Initiative Travel Grant, University of Maryland, 2023
Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, University of Maryland, 2023
Alice Rivlin Dissertation Fellowship, Brookings Institution, 2022-2024
IAAE Travel Grant, Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics, 2022
Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, University of Maryland, 2022
International Conference Student Support Award (ICSSA), University of Maryland, 2022

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2027: AEA Annual Meeting (planned)

2026: AEA Annual Meeting, System Economic Heterogeneity Conference (St. Louis Fed), SGE Annual conference, Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) Annual Meeting, European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (UEA), System Applied Micro Conference (NY Fed), North American Summer Meeting (NASM), NBER Summer Institute (Digital Economics and AI), International Association for Research in Income and Wealth (IARIW), Clemson University, Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM, planned), SEA (planned)

2025: AEA Annual Meeting, Productivity Seminar (BU Questrom), Brookings Institution, SGE Annual Conference, Society for Economic Dynamics (SED), Korean Economic Review International Conference, Econometric Society World Congress, Midwest Macro

2024: AEA Annual Meeting, Office of Tax Analysis (Treasury), Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (Treasury), U.S. Census Bureau, Federal Reserve Bank of Boston, DEI in Economics, Finance, and Central Banking, Society of Government Economists (SGE) Annual Conference, DC Urban Day, Barcelona School of Economics Summer Forum (BSE SF), UCL Stone Centre PhD Conference, WEAI Annual Conference, Federal Reserve Board (FRB), USDA, Midwest Macro, Federal Statistical Research Data Center (FSRDC) Annual Conference, BLS, Upjohn Institute, SEA Annual Meeting, NBER Conference on Competition in the U.S. Agricultural Sector, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta

2023: Western Economic Association International (WEAI) Annual Conference, Brookings Institution, WEAI International Conference, FCSM Research and Policy Conference, SEA Annual Meeting, AEA Mentoring Pipeline Conference, U.S. Census Bureau, Williams College

2022: International Conference on Public Economic Theory (PET), Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE), RWI (Berlin Office), Brookings Institution, Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting

2015: American Economic Association (AEA) Pipeline Conference

Professional Service

Referee for *B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy*
External Reviewer for the Washington Center for Equitable Growth Early Career Grant
Member, Technical Advisory Committee, Atlanta Regional Commission, 2026-Present

Languages

English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), French (proficient), Italian (beginner)

Personal

United States Citizen; Born in Miami, FL

Computational Skills

Stata, Mata, R, Matlab, Linux

References

Prof. Judith Hellerstein	University of Maryland	hellerst@umd.edu	(301) 405-3545
Prof. John Haltiwanger	University of Maryland	halt@umd.edu	(301) 405-3504
Prof. Ethan Kaplan	University of Maryland	edkaplan@umd.edu	(301) 405-3501